Overview

Level Overview

This level is a third-person linear RPG level.

The player must solve a series of puzzles within a space where the “near appears larger, far appears smaller” rule no longer applies, defeat the final boss inhabiting this space, and escape.

Story Setting

The protagonist, Lin, is a master thief. One day, he receives a private message from a mysterious individual on an online forum, commissioning him to infiltrate a private museum and steal a mysterious priest’s mask and staff.

At night, Lin infiltrates the target museum. The entire theft goes unusually smoothly, yet throughout the operation, a pair of mysterious eyes seems to be watching him.

The moment Lin obtains the mask, something goes wrong. The mask suddenly attaches itself to Lin’s face, and he loses consciousness. When he wakes up, Lin finds himself still inside the museum, but the spatial structure seems to have undergone an indescribable change, and the staff in his hand emits an unusual glow.

To escape the area, Lin begins to explore his surroundings, while a roar echoing from deep within the museum seems to hint at a hidden danger lurking in the shadows.

Design Concept

The theme of this level design test is “Scaling” and “Museum.”

Based on the level mechanic of “scaling,” I was inspired by the game 《Superliminal》. In that game, the breakdown of the “objects appear larger when closer and smaller when farther away” physical phenomenon is a transformed expression of the scaling mechanic.

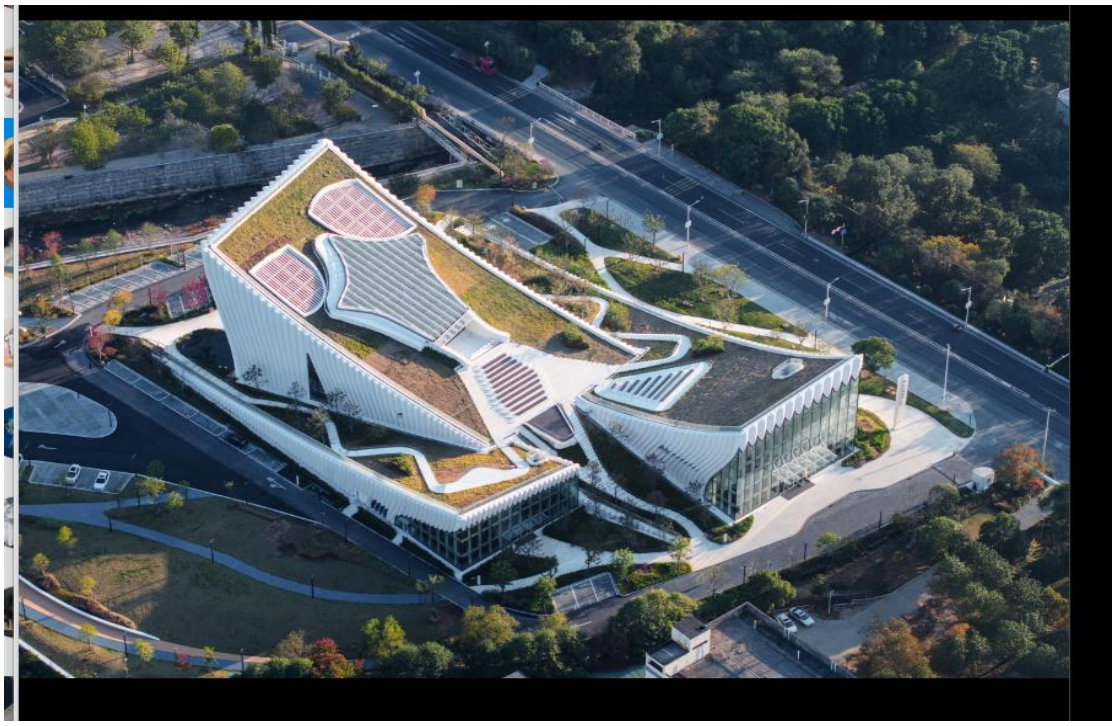
At the same time, considering the “museum” setting, I decided to incorporate fantastical elements such as dreams and cycles into the level, using the inherent mystique of the antiques to deliver a surreal, dreamlike experience for the player.

The Breakdown of Near–Far Size Perception

Revealing hidden pathways through scaling down:

The level's environmental design draws inspiration from the architecture of several world-renowned museums.
The museum's atmosphere is grand and solemn, so in the design I structured most of the level around large-scale spaces such as grand halls.
At the same time, a key characteristic of museums is their carefully planned visitor routes, so in the design I connected each section together to form a relatively strict linear level.

Referenced Museum Exterior Diagrams:



Mechanics

Level Mechanics

This level uses only one primary mechanic: the reversed application of the “near appears larger, far appears smaller” rule.

Certain objects in the environment do not follow the “near appears larger, far appears smaller” rule; when the player picks up these objects, their size remains constant in the player’s view, thereby enabling changes in the objects’ scale.

When the player picks up a distant object, it gradually becomes larger; when the player picks up a nearby object, it gradually becomes smaller.

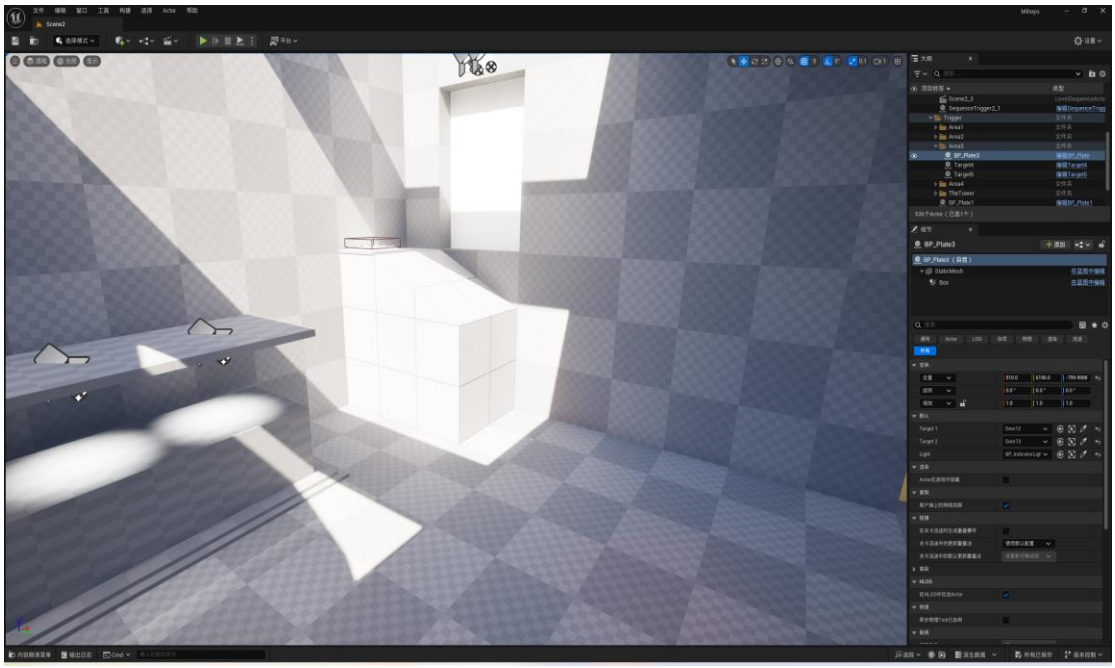
Puzzle Walkthrough

Based on this mechanic, the level features the following specific puzzle types.

1. High Platform:

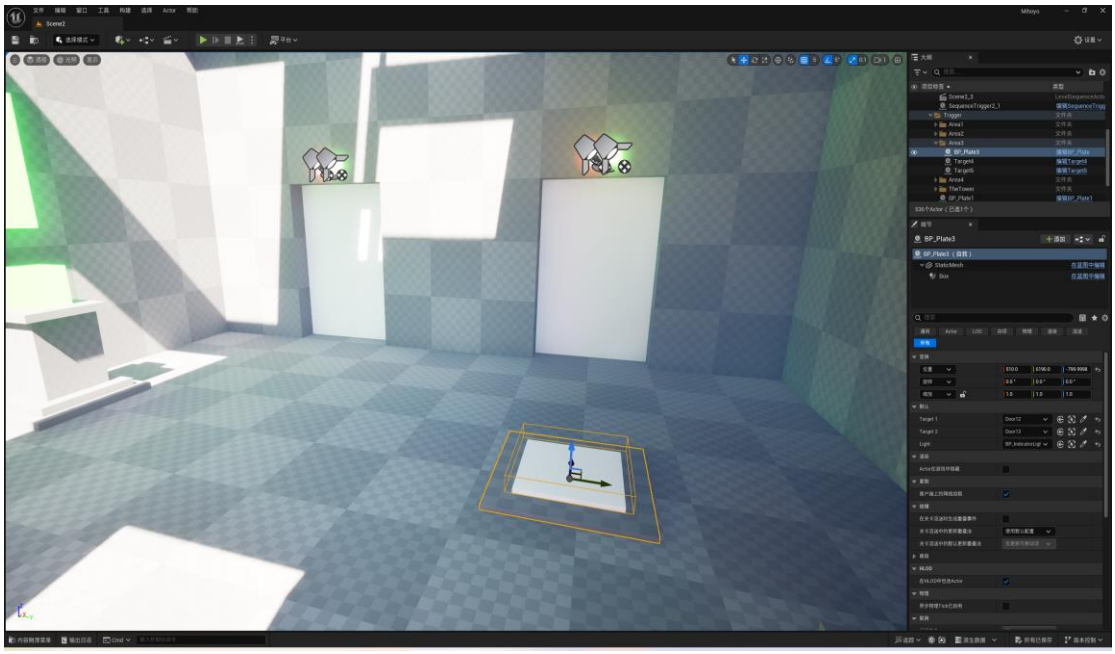
   There are several excessively high platforms in the level that players cannot reach through normal paths or by jumping.

   There are several elevated platforms in the level that the player cannot reach through normal paths or jumping alone.

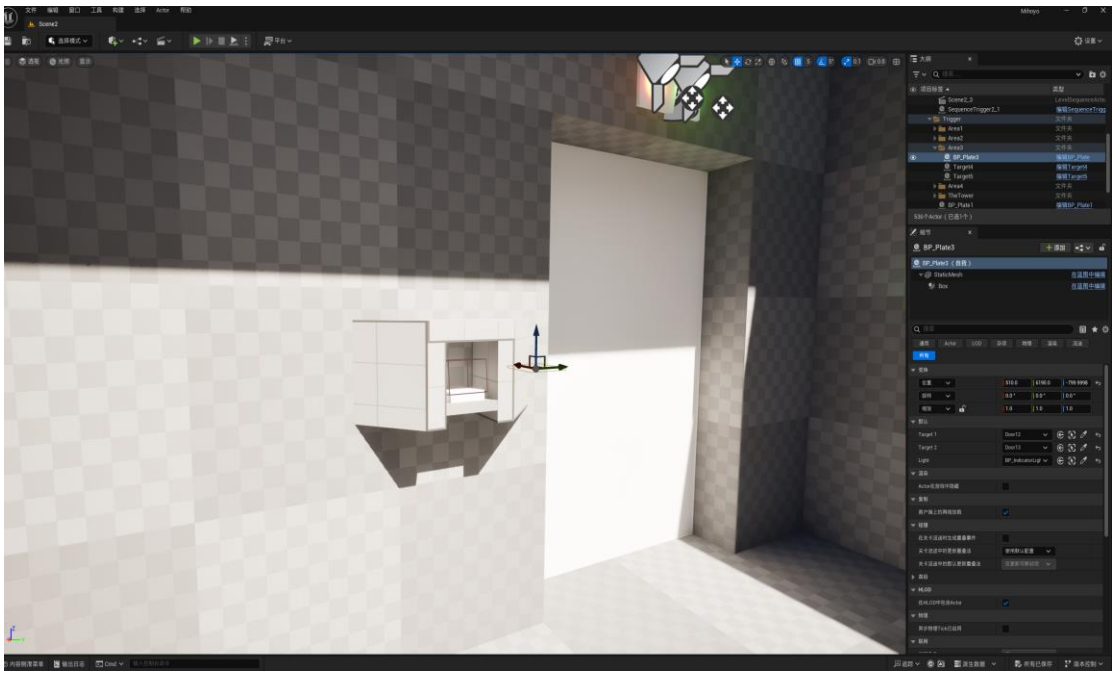


2. Pressure Plate:

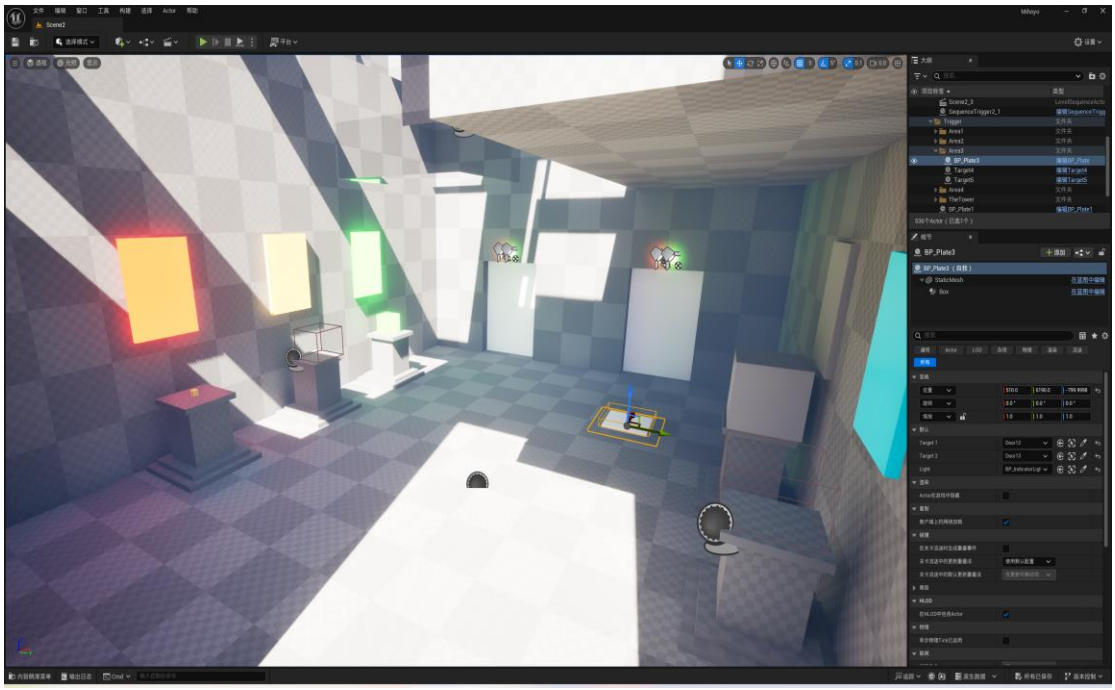
   There are locked doors in the level, each corresponding to a pressure plate switch. The player must place an object of an appropriate size on the pressure plate to unlock and open the door.



3. Narrow Gap Barrier:
   There are barriers in the level that restrict object size; players must shrink objects to an appropriate size to pass through them.



4. Environmental Puzzles:
   Some areas of the level feature specific placement patterns; players can unlock sealed gates by locating objects and arranging them correctly according to these patterns.



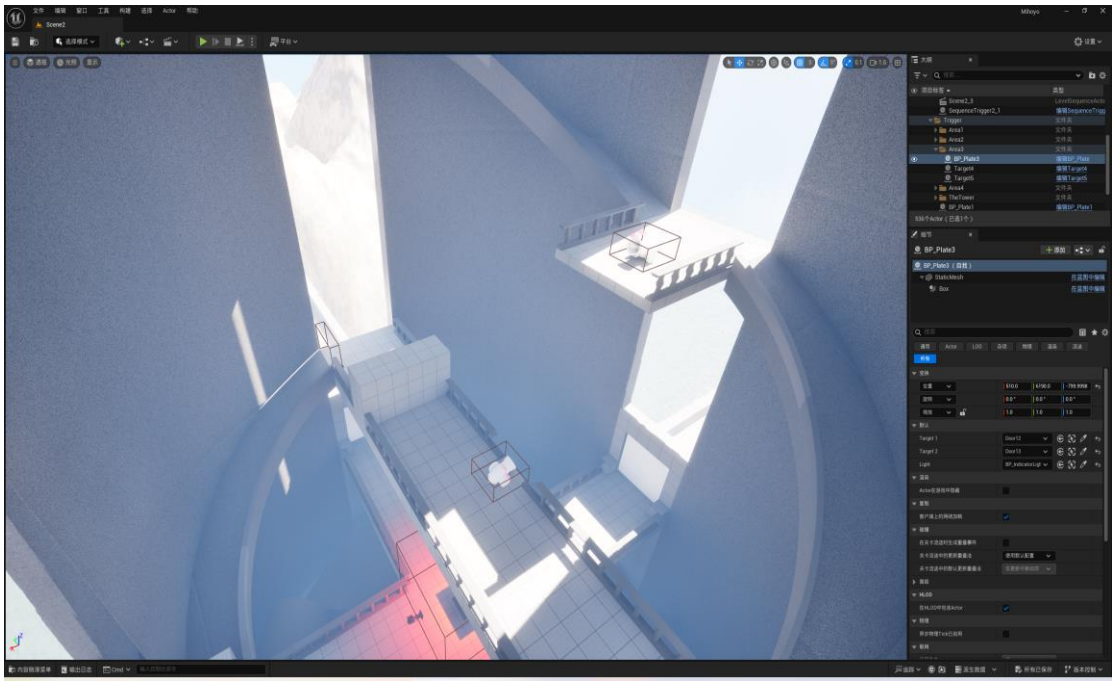
Combat Guide

A final boss is designed for this level.

The player ascends a spiraling staircase using movable blocks on the ground, while a pursuing boss lurks below, constantly giving chase.

Within the stairwell, there are several “medieval cannons,” whose size can be altered using the player’s ability; the cannons’ damage and duration of use change accordingly with their size.

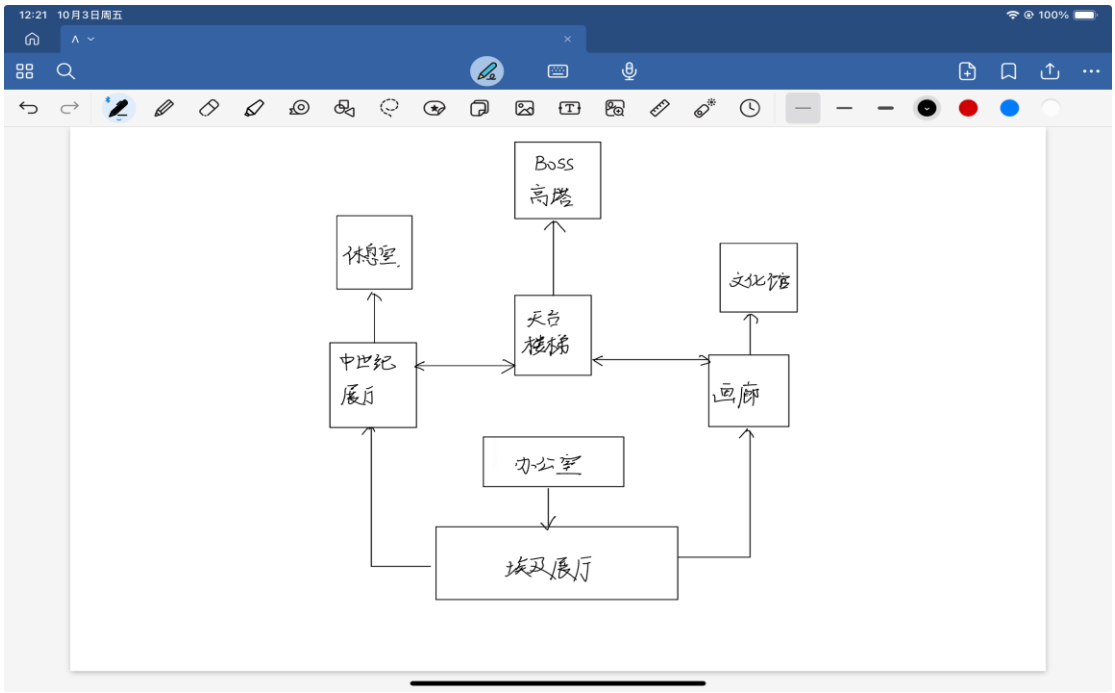
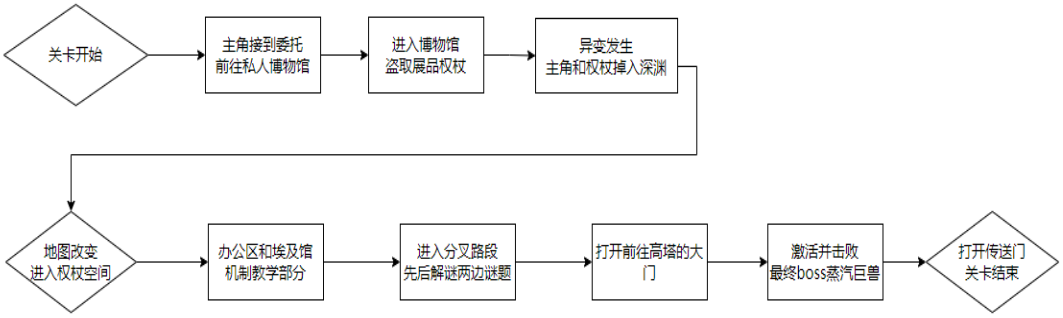
The player uses the cannons to attack the boss; defeating the boss before reaching the top of the staircase results in success, while failing to defeat the boss or being touched by it leads to failure.



Flow

Map Layout

Main Structure of Scene 2 Map



Level Flowchart